



June 28, 2023

Clinical Case Quiz

A 20-year-old male is on the intramural flag football team. He hurt his finger an hour ago during a game. It happened so quickly that he can't recall what happened. He reports 8/10 pain and swelling at the fourth right DIP joint and distal phalynx. You think this could be a sprain but have him make a fist while he's on the phone with you. He reports the second finger won't flex.

You ask him to submit a patient picture request of his fist, and the image found on the right comes through.

Based on the history and photograph, there is concern for:

- a. *Finger sprain*
- b. *Finger fracture*
- c. *Mallet finger*
- d. *Jersey finger*



Answer: d. Jersey finger

Based on the image, there is concern for jersey finger, or rupture of the flexor digitorum profundus. A pathognomonic finding is the inability to actively flex the DIP joint. The finger should be placed in a splint, and orthopedic evaluation should be made promptly. Surgical repair is the definitive treatment for all cases of complete disruption of the flexor digitorum profundus. Some cases need surgical repair within seven days.

The best next step in coordinating care would be to page orthopedics for further advice.

Additional Tips

Patient Picture Request (PPR) can be helpful in virtual care. Photographs of the skin, eyes, oropharynx, and, in this case, the extremities, can be sent easily and quickly to the VMC provider in real time.

Patients can upload a photograph via a link sent by the provider by email or text message.

[To use PPR, follow the steps in this job aid.](#)

References

Bassett, R. (n.d.). *Jersey finger examination* [Photograph]. UpToDate. <https://www.uptodate.com/contents/image?imageKey=EM%2F65933>